

"Why" worksheet

FREE TEMPLATE

Mentality, the work, the people. Under 90 seconds.

The 3-bucket "why"

#	BUCKET	WHAT GOES IN IT
1	Mentality	What about how you think or work fits this field? ("I like being measured against a clear number," "I like problems without an obvious answer.") Back it with a story.
2	2-3 specific things about the work	Real parts of the job you've learned about from calls, not from a website. ("Building a model from scratch and defending every assumption.")
3	The people and their standards	Who you've met and what stood out. ("Everyone I talked to at the firm described feedback the same way...") This is where your calls pay off.

The "why" worksheet

- ☐ Bucket 1, mentality: two traits you have that fit this work, each with a one-line story as proof.
- ☐ Bucket 2, the work: three specific tasks you'd do in the role. Where did you learn about each one? (Which call?)
- ☐ Bucket 3, the people: two people you've spoken with and one thing each said that stuck with you.
- ☐ Why this firm: one thing only this firm does, one person you've talked to there, and one reason it fits your bucket 1.
- ☐ Say it out loud in under 90 seconds. Record it. Cut anything a hundred other students could say.

EXAMPLE ONLY. A MADE-UP ANSWER SHOWING THE 3 BUCKETS.

"I've always liked work where you're measured against a clear number: I ran the register at a coffee shop and tracked our end-of-night counts to zero errors (mentality). From my calls this fall, what pulls me in is building a model from scratch and then having to defend every assumption to someone senior, and seeing a deal from the first pitch to close (the work). And every analyst I talked to at your firm described feedback the same way: direct, fast, and meant to make you better. That's the environment I want to start my career in (the people)."